

TELECOM MARKET INTELLIGENCE — MONTHLY PULSE

Belarus Telecommunications Market

June 2026 — Competitive Intensity Brief

Run date: 2026-06-09

Operators covered: A1 Belarus, MTS Belarus, life:) (Turkcell)

Research window: Last 90 days (baseline refresh: 18 months)

Research note: Belarus is subject to comprehensive EU and US sanctions. English-language financial reporting on Belarusian operators is sparse; per-operator revenue and subscriber share data is not publicly available. All figures are estimated from aggregated sources and should be treated as indicative.

Year So Far

Belarus's mobile market entered 2026 defined by a single structural event: the April 2025 presidential decree (No. 139) mandating a state-controlled, single-infrastructure 5G rollout under beCloud, foreclosing independent operator network builds. Competitive intensity on infrastructure is effectively neutralised — operators compete on tariffs and service overlay, not network ownership. MTS holds the subscriber lead, A1 is second, and life:) trails distantly — a gap that has not materially shifted. The market's 11.4 million connections (127% penetration) leave minimal room for net subscriber growth, pushing competition toward ARPU defence.

Last 90 Days

DIRECTIONAL VERDICT

Stable — Competitive intensity is structurally contained by state-mandated shared 5G infrastructure and social tariff caps; operators are differentiated by service overlay and brand rather than network or price, and no market share disruption is imminent.

- **Infrastructure — 5G via beCloud decree** — Lukashenko signed Decree No. 139 on 1 April 2025, designating beCloud as sole 5G infrastructure operator for a decade-long rollout; grants tax/regulatory preferences for 10 years, locking in the shared-network model and removing infrastructure as a competitive lever. ([president.gov.by, 2025-04-01](https://president.gov.by/2025-04-01))
- **5G launch — life:) first, MTS surpasses** — life:) was the first operator to fully commercialise 5G (>1,000 beCloud base stations); MTS Belarus subsequently launched with 1,100 stations, surpassing life:); coverage live in Minsk, Brest, Vitsyebsk, Mahiliou, Homiel. ([REFORM.news, 2025–2026](#); [Foro3D, 2026-04](#))
- **Pricing — social tariff floor** — Presidential decree (April 2025) mandated basic social tariffs for all operators, capping downside pricing; competition plays

out through unlimited bundles (A1 Drive Unlimited at BYN 39.90/month; MTS Bezlमितishe at BYN 26.75/month) and aggressive MNP promotions above the floor. ([Telecompaper, 2025–2026](#))

- **A1 deepens — acquires fixed operators** — Rather than exiting, A1 Group acquired Belarusian fixed-line operators AtlantTelecom and TeleSet in 2025, creating a full FMC operator; Belarus contributes ~8% of A1 Group revenues and ~10% of EBITDA, making it financially material. ([Connectivity Business News, 2025](#))
- **Sanctions — EU tightens, US eases** — EU adopted 18th (July 2025) and 20th (April 2026) sanctions packages progressively broadening Belarus measures; US OFAC simultaneously relaxed Belarus sanctions from September 2025 onward (political prisoner releases). The divergence creates asymmetric risk for EU-headquartered A1 Group. ([EU Council, 2025-12](#); [OFAC, 2026-03](#))
- **MTS network quality award** — BelGIE (the state quality regulator) named MTS Belarus best mobile network of 2025 with a score of 886/1,000 — the first formal quality ranking under the new assessment framework, giving MTS a defensive brand claim. ([Telecompaper, 2025](#))

Outlook to Year-End

- **5G Phase 1 completion (Minsk, 2025–2027 target)** — beCloud targets 70% Minsk coverage within two years of April 2025 decree; completion would push operators to differentiate on 5G service/bundles; delay is more probable given state infrastructure execution track record.
- **A1 Belarus compliance review** — EU sanctions explicitly prohibit supplying telecom services to Belarus; A1 Group operates under a compliance framework not publicly disclosed. Any EU enforcement action or inquiry would force a divestiture process; the 20th sanctions package (April 2026) increases this risk.
- **Social tariff floor review** — Presidential decree pricing mandates are subject to government review; any upward revision allows ARPU recovery and eases competitive pressure; a freeze or tightening further suppresses differentiation. Timing: ad hoc, no scheduled review.

Sources

Lukashenko signs Decree No. 139 on 5G investment project — [president.gov.by](#), 2025-04-01

Lukashenko signs decree on 5G technology in Belarus — [BELTA](#), 2025-04-01

Life Launches 5G Network — [REFORM.news](#), 2025–2026

Belarusian MTS Announces Launch of 5G Service — [REFORM.news](#), 2026

MTS launches full 5G network in Belarus — [Foro3D](#), 2026-04

[Telekom Austria acquires AtlantTelecom and TeleSet](#) — Connectivity Business News, 2025

[MTS Belarus named best mobile network in 2025 by regulator](#) — Telecompaper, 2025

[A1 Belarus Drive Unlimited promotion](#) — Telecompaper, 2025–2026

[Beltelecom MTS Belarus expand convergent package](#) — Telecompaper, 2026

[EU Council broadens scope of Belarus sanctions — December 2025](#) — EU Council, 2025-12-15

[OFAC Belarus sanctions relief](#) — OFAC, 2026-03-26

[EU adopts 20th sanctions package](#) — Mayer Brown, 2026-04

[Belarus Presidential Decree Sets Stage for Nationwide 5G Rollout](#) — Global Validity, 2025

[Belarus 5G Rollout: Minsk 2025 to Nationwide Coverage by 2034](#) — FindIt.City, 2025

[Digital 2026: Belarus](#) — DataReportal, 2026

[Belarus Telecom MNO Market Size, Share & 2030 Trends](#) — Mordor Intelligence, 2025

[Life Belarus expands 5G, LTE networks, implements HD Voice](#) — Telecompaper, 2026